



▲ **The narrow-gauge** trains of the Darjeeling Himalayan Railway run on an elevation that varies from 100 m to 2,200 m, and cross through semi-tropical valleys, tea plantations, lush forests, and villages.

“It seems almost sacrilegious to desecrate those lofty crags with man’s petty contrivances,” commented writer DT Timins in the 1897 October edition of *The Railway Magazine*, as he gazed at the mountains on his maiden train journey to Darjeeling. Yet, with the passing of each steep curve and formidable loop, through tea gardens, dense forests, and deep ravines, he could not help but wax eloquent on “one of the most marvellous triumphs of modern engineering skill.” The 88-km, 2-ft line connecting Siliguri to Darjeeling in West Bengal quickly became a